

AAPO VANHAINEN

<https://aapovanhainen.github.io/portfolio/> • aapo.vanhainen@gmail.com • [linkedin.com/in/aapo-vanhainen](https://www.linkedin.com/in/aapo-vanhainen)

Game Designer / Gameplay & Systems

Game developer focused on gameplay design, combat systems, and implementation. Worked on commercial, professional training, and student projects using Unity. Experience includes designing and implementing combat mechanics, enemy behavior, player abilities, balance, and supporting systems, alongside documentation, QA, and cross-disciplinary collaboration. Portfolio also includes game audio, AI systems, and board game design projects.

PROJECTS

Exsanguination • 09/2024 - 12/2024

Never Late Production

- Designed melee combat systems including attacks, combos, parry mechanics, movement abilities, and player feedback
- Designed and implemented enemy behaviors and combat encounters
- Implemented gameplay logic in Unity, integrating combat, AI, animation, and audio triggers
- Wrote and maintained the Game Design Document (GDD) and Audio Design Document (ADD)
- Mentored a junior programmer on gameplay systems and Unity implementation
- Side work: Sound effect creation, Foley recording, audio editing, and in-engine audio implementation (documented separately in audio portfolio)

Versebound • 01/2025 - 04/2025

Conifer Digital

- Worked on core gameplay systems, player abilities, and progression
- Balanced enemies, combat pacing, and difficulty through iteration and playtesting
- Implemented gameplay features and system logic in Unity
- Participated in QA, testing gameplay scenarios and validating fixes

Neverance • 10/2025 - 12/2025

Gangster Pukeko Games

- Designed and implemented gameplay-supporting systems and interaction logic
- Implemented dialogue systems integrated with gameplay flow
- Documented systems to support clarity, iteration, and future development

Board Games • 01/2020 - 12/2022

Co-designed multiple tabletop game projects focused on systems-driven design, balance, and iteration. Responsible for core rule systems, combat mechanics, class abilities, progression, and economy design. Led balancing passes through repeated playtesting, adjusting values, rules, and interactions to improve clarity, pacing, and player decision-making. Produced written rulesets to support iteration and testing.

SKILLS

Tools: Jira, Miro, Office tools

Design & Gameplay: Balance & iteration, Combat systems, Encounter design, Enemy behavior, Player abilities

Documentation & Collaboration:

Cross-disciplinary teamwork, GDD / ADD writing, Mentoring

Board Games: Co-designed multiple tabletop games focusing on systems, balance, and iteration

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Business Information Technology — Game Production

Jyväskylä University of Applied Sciences

GPA: 4.5 / 5

12/2025

- Researched Foley production practices in indie game development
- Developed a practical analysis tool for audio production feasibility
- Thesis:
<https://www.theseus.fi/handle/10024/908930>
- Foley sound analyzing tool:
<https://github.com/aapovanhainen/Foley-Sound-Analyzing-Tool>